Social engineering: hacking people



Cyber security · Level 3 · Lesson 2

In this lesson you will

- Explain what social engineering is and why it works.
- Name the five tricks in calls, messages, game chats and in person.
- Respond safely: pause, check through another channel, say no.

Five tricks, one defence

- Authority, urgency, fear, a gift, curiosity
- Knowing your name proves nothing
- Real help lets you call back, and never asks for codes
- Pause, check another way, never share

Trick spotting

1. Collect (4 min): Write down three scam messages or calls you've heard of.
2. Spot (6 min): Name the tricks in each one.
3. Rewrite (6 min): Write the best reply to each.
4. Teach (4 min): Explain one to someone at home.

Work with real examples, but never call back a scam number or reply to a scam message, even as a joke.

Think about it

1. Why do attackers try to make you feel rushed or scared?
2. How can you check a call without using the number it came from?
3. When is it hard to say no, and how can you make it easier?

Before you go

- One trick + the words I’ll use to say no to it.